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CHAPTER 1

Lesson Planning

60 PROMPTS

Most lesson planning goes wrong in the same place: you start listing activities before deciding what would count as proof the lesson worked.

The Teacher AI Toolkit

Works in ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini

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Chapter 1 — Lesson Planning

60 PROMPTS

Most lesson planning goes wrong in the same place: you start listing activities before deciding what would count as proof the lesson worked. These prompts push the evidence to the front — what will you actually see in the room that tells you they got it — and build backward from there.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Complete lessons	12	You need the whole thing, start to finish
Backward unit planning	8	You have three weeks and an end assessment
Standards and objectives	8	Turning official wording into something teachable
Warm-ups and exit tickets	8	The first five minutes and the last five
Pacing and transitions	6	The lesson is right but the timing is not
Substitute and emergency plans	6	You are ill at 6am
Projects and interdisciplinary	6	Longer work, more than one subject
Reflection and adaptation	6	It did not go as planned; now what

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Give it the real constraints — 50 minutes, 26 students, no lab this week. Vague input produces a plan for a class that does not exist.

If a standard has to be followed, paste its exact wording. Never ask the model to recall a standard code; it will produce something that looks right.

Treat every suggested timing as optimistic. Handing out paper takes four minutes.

COMPLETE LESSONS

LP-001**Build a complete evidence-led lesson**Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You have an objective and a slot in the schedule, and nothing else yet.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC].

Objective: [OBJECTIVE – what students should be able to do by the end]

Class: [CLASS SIZE, anything I should know about the group]

Available: [MATERIALS, room, technology – say if there is none]

Build it backward. Decide first what you would need to see from a student to believe they met the objective, then design the lesson to produce exactly that.

Give me:

1. The objective as a student-facing "I can" statement
2. A 5-minute opening that surfaces what they already know
3. The modeling steps, in the order I say and do them
4. Guided practice, plus what I should look for while circulating
5. Independent practice
6. An exit ticket – one question that separates real understanding from students who followed the steps without understanding
7. The most common misconception on this topic, and the exact question I ask to catch it

Keep every section short enough to read at a glance while teaching. If any of my inputs are missing or too vague to plan from, ask me before drafting.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does every activity produce evidence about the objective?
- Could a student who understood nothing still answer the exit ticket?
- Are the materials ones you genuinely have this week?

LP-006**Plan a concept-development lesson from prior knowledge**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The concept is new, but they already hold pieces of it without knowing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson that develops the concept of [CONCEPT], starting from what students already know.

Already taught: [PRIOR LEARNING]

Do not open by defining the concept. Instead:

1. Start with 2-3 examples they can already reason about
2. Add one example their current thinking cannot explain
3. Give them the question that gap creates, and let them work on it
4. Introduce the concept as the answer to that question
5. Return to the first examples so they can see what changed

For each stage, tell me what a student still holding the old idea would say, so

I can hear it while circulating.

End with a check that distinguishes a student who has the new concept from one who has memorized the new vocabulary.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the "cannot explain" example genuinely unexplainable with prior knowledge?
- Does the definition arrive after the need for it, not before?

LP-007**Plan an inquiry lesson around a puzzling phenomenon**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want them asking the question rather than answering yours.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] inquiry lesson about [TOPIC].

Available materials: [MATERIALS – say if this must be paper only]

Open with something genuinely puzzling students can observe or examine directly, not a question I ask them.

Give me:

- The phenomenon, described exactly as students will encounter it
- What students typically notice first, and what they usually miss
- Three questions students are likely to raise, and which is most productive to pursue
- How I steer toward the productive question without announcing it
- The point where I give direct instruction, and why there
- A closing that names what is now explained and what is still open

If the phenomenon needs equipment I have not listed, say so rather than assuming I have it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the phenomenon actually puzzling, or just unfamiliar?
- Is there a point where you teach directly? Pure discovery rarely works.

LP-008**Create an explicit-instruction lesson with guided release**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A procedure where practicing it wrong first would be costly.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson teaching [SKILL OR PROCEDURE] using explicit instruction with gradual release.

Structure it as I do it / we do it / you do it together / you do it alone, with rough timings.

For "I do it": write out the exact worked example, including what I say aloud about the decisions I am making – not just the steps.

For "we do it": two examples where I hand over one more decision each time. Name which decision is being handed over.

For "you do it together": the task, plus the one thing pairs usually get wrong.

For "you do it alone": three items increasing in difficulty, with answers.

Between each phase, tell me the checkpoint – what I need to see before moving on, and what I do if I do not see it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the worked example include the thinking, or only the steps?
- Is there a stated checkpoint before each release?

LP-009**Design a discussion-centered lesson with equitable participation**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The same six students answer everything and you want that to change.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] discussion lesson on [TOPIC OR TEXT] for [NUMBER] students.

Design it so a quiet student has a real route in.

Give me:

- An opening question with no single right answer, that everyone can say something about
- A silent thinking or writing step before any talking
- A pairs step, with the exact instruction students hear
- Two follow-up questions that push for evidence rather than opinion
- Three moves for when discussion stalls, and three for when a few voices dominate
- A closing task each student completes alone, so participation is not the only evidence I get

Do not suggest cold-calling as the main participation strategy.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is there thinking time before talking time?
- Does a student who says nothing still leave evidence you can read?

LP-010**Build a no-technology lesson using basic classroom materials**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The wifi is down, the trolley is booked, or you simply do not want screens.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC] using nothing but paper, pens, a board, and what is already in an ordinary classroom.

No printing – assume I cannot photocopy anything this morning. Anything students need to see must be writable on the board or dictated.

Give me:

- Exactly what I write on the board, and when
- The task, worded as I would say it aloud
- How students record their work on plain paper
- A way to share answers that does not need a document camera
- An exit ticket on a scrap of paper

This should not feel like a downgraded technology lesson. Use the constraint – physical grouping, movement, talk – as an advantage.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could this actually run with zero preparation this morning?
- Is anything here secretly assuming a printer?

LP-011**Create a lesson around one complex text or source**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One difficult text, and you want them to work through it rather than survive it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson built around the text below.

Do not summarize the text for students. Design a lesson that makes them work through it.

Give me:

- The two or three places students will get stuck, quoted exactly, and what to do at each
- A first-read task with a single narrow purpose
- A second-read task that goes deeper, not wider
- Four text-dependent questions from literal to inferential, with the lines that answer each
- The vocabulary that genuinely blocks comprehension – not merely unfamiliar words – with a student-friendly gloss
- A final writing or talking task using evidence from the text

TEXT:

[PASTE THE FULL TEXT HERE]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the quoted sticking points actually appear in your text?
- Is the second read deeper, or just more of the same?

LP-012**Plan a safe hands-on investigation lesson**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Practical work, where safety is part of the plan and not an afterthought.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] hands-on investigation into [QUESTION OR PHENOMENON].

Equipment I actually have: [LIST]

Room: [BENCHES, SINKS, SPACE, CLASS SIZE]

Give me:

- The investigation question in student words
- Setup, including how materials are distributed and collected
- What students record, and the exact table or format they record it in
- The safety points specific to this activity, stated as instructions rather than warnings
- What to do about the group that finishes in half the time
- A discussion that separates what they observed from what they concluded

Flag anything needing equipment I have not listed, or that my room as described cannot support. Do not assume a fume hood, gas or running water unless I said so.

I will check all safety guidance against my school's own procedures.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check every safety point against your school's policy, not this draft.
- Is the equipment list what you actually have on the day?

LP-013**Design a problem-based mathematics lesson**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want them to need the method before you teach it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] mathematics lesson on [TOPIC].

Open with a problem students can start without being taught the method – one where an inefficient approach works but becomes painful, so the method answers a need they have felt.

Give me:

- The problem, with numbers chosen so the inefficient route is possible but tedious
- Two student approaches I should expect, one efficient and one not
- The exact question I ask to move a student from the second to the first
- Where the formal method gets named, and how it connects to what they did
- Three practice items: one like the problem, one varying the surface, one varying the structure
- Answers, with working shown

Check every calculation. State any assumption you made about the numbers.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Work all the numbers yourself. This is where wrong answers hide.
- Does the inefficient route genuinely work, or break immediately?

LP-014**Compress a full lesson into a purposeful 30-minute period**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

An assembly, a fire drill, a shortened day — and the lesson still has to land.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Cut the lesson below down to [MINUTES] minutes for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Do not trim every section evenly. Decide what the lesson is really for, protect that, and cut the rest properly.

Tell me:

- The one thing that must survive, and why
- What you cut completely, and what is lost by cutting it
- What moves to next lesson, and what that costs
- The compressed plan with realistic timings
- A one-question check that still tells me whether it worked

If the lesson genuinely cannot be done in this time without losing its point, say so and tell me what a better use of the [MINUTES] minutes would be.

LESSON:

[PASTE YOUR PLAN]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with what it decided was essential?
- Is the timing realistic, or does it assume instant transitions?

LP-015**Expand a lesson for a 90-minute block without filler**

Grades 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A double period, and you refuse to fill it with extra questions.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Extend the [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson below to fill [MINUTES] minutes.

Do not add more practice items of the same kind. Add depth: application, transfer, comparison, or students producing something rather than answering.

Give me:

- The extended plan, with the activity type changing roughly every 15-20 minutes
- At least one point where students move or work with someone new
- A mid-block reset – what I say and do at the halfway point
- One task using the idea in an unfamiliar context
- The point in the block where attention usually drops, and what is placed there

Do not extend by simply increasing the number of questions.

LESSON:

[PASTE YOUR PLAN]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the extra time depth or volume?
- Is anything needing attention placed in the low-attention slot?

LP-016**Repair a draft lesson whose activities do not match its objective**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The plan looks fine, but something about it is not adding up.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit the [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson below against its stated objective.

For each activity, tell me:

- What it actually asks students to do, cognitively
- Whether that matches the objective, partly matches, or does not match
- What evidence about the objective it produces, if any

Then give me the single biggest mismatch and a replacement activity for it that keeps the same time and materials.

Be direct. If the objective itself is the problem – too vague to plan against, or two objectives in one sentence – say that first.

OBJECTIVE: [PASTE IT]

LESSON:
[PASTE YOUR PLAN]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with the mismatch it identified?
- Does the replacement fit your actual time and materials?

BACKWARD UNIT PLANNING

LP-002**Plan a unit backward from mastery**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three weeks, an assessment at the end, and no clear path between them.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Plan a [NUMBER]-lesson [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit on [TOPIC].

The unit ends with: [FINAL ASSESSMENT OR PERFORMANCE]

Already taught: [PRIOR LEARNING]

Work backward. Start from what a student must be able to do to succeed on that final assessment, then sequence everything needed to get there.

Give me:

- The 4-6 things students must be able to do by the end
- Those sequenced across the lessons, with a one-line reason for the order
- Which lessons are load-bearing and which could be cut if we lose time
- A checkpoint roughly every third lesson, and what I do if it goes badly
- The two lessons most likely to go wrong, and why

Mark optional extensions separately from the core sequence, so I can see at a glance what is expendable.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does each lesson clearly serve the final assessment?
- Are the checkpoints early enough to act on?

LP-017**Unpack final mastery into a prerequisite learning map**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You know the destination; you are not sure what has to come first.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] end goal – [END GOAL] – map what has to be in place first.

Give me:

- The component skills and knowledge, broken down until each could be taught and checked in a single lesson
- Which depend on which, as an ordered list rather than a vague cluster
- Which are usually already secure by [GRADE], and which usually are not
- For each shaky one, a two-minute check I could run before the unit starts

Do not include anything students do not actually need for this goal. A shorter honest list is more useful than a complete-looking one.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is each component small enough to teach in one lesson?
- Are the dependencies real, or just a plausible-looking order?

LP-018**Design a final performance task before planning daily lessons**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Writing the ending first, so the middle has somewhere to go.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design the final performance task for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit on [TOPIC].

Learning it must evidence: [WHAT STUDENTS SHOULD BE ABLE TO DO]

Time available: [MINUTES OR LESSONS]

Give me:

- The task as students will receive it, written out in full
- What a strong response contains, specifically
- What a response looks like when a student has the knowledge but not the skill
- What it looks like when they have the skill but thin knowledge
- Which parts of the task are about the learning and which are about presentation – so I do not accidentally grade the poster

Keep it completable in the time given, with the materials a normal classroom has.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student do well on this without the learning? Redesign if so.
- Is presentation separated from substance?

LP-019**Create a coherent lesson sequence from an approved assessment**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The assessment is fixed and handed to you; the teaching is yours.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Below is the assessment my [GRADE] [SUBJECT] students sit at the end of this unit. I have [NUMBER] lessons before it.

Work out what it actually demands, then plan the sequence.

Give me:

- What each question or section requires, as a skill rather than a topic
- Anything the assessment expects that the topic list alone would not give students – format, command words, time pressure
- A lesson sequence building toward it without becoming test practice
- Where I should give them a question in this format for the first time
- What I would be teaching only for the test, so I can decide whether it is worth the time

ASSESSMENT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is it teaching the learning or teaching the paper?
- Do students meet the format early enough that it is not a surprise?

LP-020**Place formative checkpoints and reteaching decisions across a unit**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want to find out who is lost before the end of the unit.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For the [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit below, place formative checkpoints.

Give me:

- Where they go, and why there specifically
- What each one checks – one thing, not a general review
- The actual question or task for each, short enough to mark in ten minutes
- What each result would show: what it looks like when most of the class is fine, and what it looks like when it has gone wrong
- For each checkpoint, the specific reteach for next lesson if it went badly – not "revisit the concept"

Do not set a pass percentage. Describe what the responses would show; the decision about moving on is mine.

UNIT:

[PASTE YOUR OUTLINE]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is each reteach concrete enough to teach tomorrow?
- Can you genuinely mark each checkpoint in ten minutes?

LP-021**Audit a unit for gaps, repetition and cognitive progression**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The unit exists. You want to know what is wrong with it before you teach it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit.

Tell me:

- Where a lesson assumes something never taught
- Where the same thing is taught twice without deepening
- Whether cognitive demand rises across the unit or stays flat – say which lessons sit at which level
- Which lesson does the most work, and which does the least
- What a student who missed lessons [X] and [Y] would be unable to do

Be blunt. I would rather hear that a lesson is redundant than get a tactful list of strengths.

UNIT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with the gaps, or is it missing context you hold in your head?
- Is the flat-demand judgment fair?

LP-022**Shorten a unit while protecting its essential learning**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Snow days, assemblies, a lost week — and the unit still has to finish.

COPY THIS PROMPT

I have lost [NUMBER] lessons from this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit. Cut it down.

Give me:

- What must survive, and why each item is non-negotiable
- What gets cut entirely, and what students will not be able to do as a result
- What gets merged rather than cut, and how
- The revised sequence
- What I should tell students, if anything, about what we are skipping

If shortening it this much would leave the unit incoherent, say so and tell me what a better plan would be – including teaching less content properly.

UNIT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are you comfortable with what it cut? You know the class; it does not.
- Does the shortened version still reach the final assessment?

LP-023**Add transfer and reflection to the end of a unit**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They can do it in the unit's context and nowhere else.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a closing lesson for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] unit on [TOPIC] that tests whether the learning transfers.

Give me:

- A task in a context we never used during the unit, needing the same thinking
- What a student who only learned the surface pattern will do with it
- A reflection prompt about the thinking, not about how they felt
- A short comparison task: here is something similar but different – which applies, and how do you know
- What I should look for in their answers as evidence of real transfer

Do not make the closing lesson a review of what we already did.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the new context genuinely new, or a cosmetic change?
- Does the reflection ask about thinking rather than feeling?

STANDARDS AND OBJECTIVES

LP-003**Turn a standard into measurable objectives**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The standard is a paragraph. You need something you can teach on Tuesday.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Break the standard below into teachable objectives for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Give me:

- 3-5 objectives, each small enough to teach and check in one lesson
- Each written with a verb I could observe – not "understand" or "appreciate"
- For each, what a student does that shows it
- The order to teach them, with a reason
- Anything in the standard not covered by these objectives, so I can see what I am leaving out

Use only the wording I paste below. Do not add requirements from other versions of this standard, and do not fill gaps with what a standard like this usually says.

STANDARD:

[PASTE THE EXACT WORDING]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check the objectives against the standard's real wording, not a paraphrase.
- Is every verb observable?

LP-024**Separate knowledge, skill and reasoning within a standard**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Students can recite it but cannot use it, or use it but cannot explain it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For the [GRADE] [SUBJECT] standard below, separate what students must know, what they must be able to do, and what they must be able to reason about.

For each of the three:

- List the specific items
- Say how each is best taught, given what kind of thing it is
- Say how each is best checked – the check for knowledge should not look like the check for reasoning

Then tell me which of the three this standard is really about, and which is usually over-taught at the expense of the others.

STANDARD:

[PASTE THE EXACT WORDING]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the three checks genuinely test different things?
- Does the emphasis match what the standard actually says?

LP-025**Rewrite a technical objective as a student-friendly I-can statement**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The objective on your board means nothing to the students reading it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite the objective below as an "I can" statement for [GRADE] students.

Rules:

- Keep the full demand. Do not make it easier to state by making it easier.
- Use words a [GRADE] student already uses, not words they would have to be taught.
- One sentence.

Give me three versions at different levels of directness, and say which you would put on the board and why.

Then give me success criteria as 2-3 "I know I've got it when..." lines a student could check themselves against.

OBJECTIVE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the demand intact, or has it quietly been lowered?
- Could a student self-check against those criteria without asking you?

LP-026**Create observable success criteria for an existing objective**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You know what good looks like. You have never written it down.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write success criteria for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] objective: [OBJECTIVE]

The task students will do: [TASK]

Give me 3-5 criteria, each something I could point at in a student's work and say yes or no. No criterion should require me to judge effort or attitude.

For each criterion:

- What it looks like when met
- What it most commonly looks like when nearly met
- The feedback sentence I would give for the nearly-met version

Order them so the first is the one that matters most.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could two teachers apply these and agree?
- Is anything here about effort rather than the work?

LP-027**Check whether an activity truly aligns to a supplied standard**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It is a good activity. You are not sure it is the right one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Check whether this activity addresses the standard below.

Tell me:

- What the standard actually demands, in plain words
- What the activity actually asks students to do
- Where these match and where they do not
- What the activity does that the standard does not require – and whether that is worth the time
- What the standard requires that the activity never touches

End with a straight verdict: fully aligned, partly aligned, or not aligned. If partly, tell me the smallest change that would fix it.

STANDARD:

[PASTE THE EXACT WORDING]

ACTIVITY:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the verdict based on your standard's real wording?
- Is the "smallest change" actually small?

LP-028**Map several objectives into a logical teaching order**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A list of objectives with no indication of what comes first.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Put these [GRADE] [SUBJECT] objectives into a teaching order.

For each position, tell me why it sits there – what it needs from what came before, or what it sets up for what follows.

Then tell me:

- Which pairs could be taught in either order without harm
- Which pair would cause real trouble if reversed, and what that trouble is
- Which objectives could be combined into one lesson
- Which single objective will need more than one lesson

If two objectives are actually the same thing worded differently, say so.

OBJECTIVES:

[PASTE THE LIST]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the stated dependencies hold up when you think through a lesson?
- Does the total lesson count fit the time you have?

LP-029**Identify prerequisite skills without lowering the grade-level target**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Some of the class is not ready, and the target is not moving.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] objective – [OBJECTIVE] – identify the prerequisite skills.

Give me:

- The prerequisites, ordered from most to least likely to be missing at [GRADE]
- A short diagnostic for each: 2-3 items, answers included
- For each, the fastest way to shore it up inside a lesson aimed at the grade-level objective, rather than as separate remediation

The grade-level target does not change. I want what to scaffold alongside it, not what to substitute for it.

Do not suggest teaching a lower-grade version of the objective instead.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the target intact?
- Can the scaffolds run inside a normal lesson, or do they need extra time?

LP-030**Write evidence statements showing what mastery would look like**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before planning the teaching, you want the finish line described precisely.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] objective – [OBJECTIVE] – write evidence statements.

Each should describe something a student produces, says or does that would convince a colleague they have met the objective.

Give me:

- 4-5 evidence statements, from minimum sufficient to clearly beyond
- For each, an example of what that looks like in actual work
- The one piece of evidence to prioritize if I only have time for one
- Two things students often produce that look like evidence but are not, and why

Do not attach grades or percentages to these.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a colleague reading these agree the student met the objective?
- Are the false-positive examples ones you actually see?

WARM-UPS AND EXIT TICKETS

LP-004**Create a matched warm-up and exit ticket**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want the first five minutes and the last five to answer the same question.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC] with the objective [OBJECTIVE], write
a matched pair: a warm-up and an exit ticket.

They must test the same thing, so that comparing them tells me what the lesson changed.

Give me:

- The warm-up: one question, answerable in 3 minutes, that a student could attempt before the lesson
- The exit ticket: the same demand, different surface, so they cannot pass by remembering the warm-up
- The answer to each
- What it means if a student gets the warm-up right and the exit ticket wrong
- What it means if most of the class gets both right – including whether the lesson was needed

Both should fit on a quarter sheet of paper.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the exit ticket a genuine variant, not a copy?
- Could you mark thirty of these in ten minutes?

LP-031**Design a warm-up that exposes prior knowledge in five minutes**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You are about to teach something that depends on last year, and you are not sure last year happened.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a 5-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] warm-up that tells me what students already know about [PRIOR TOPIC] before I teach [NEW TOPIC].

It should surface what they know without feeling like a test.

Give me:

- The task, written as students see it
- The three levels of response I should expect, from secure to not-yet
- For each level, the one thing I would change about today's lesson
- A version I can run entirely verbally if paper is not practical

Do not include anything from the new topic. This is diagnosis, not a preview.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does it genuinely avoid the new content?
- Can you sort thirty responses into the three levels while walking around?

LP-032**Write a misconception-revealing hinge question**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The moment mid-lesson where you decide whether to move on.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a hinge question for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC], to use at the point where I decide whether to move on.

Requirements:

- Multiple choice, 4 options, answerable in under a minute
- Every wrong option must correspond to a specific, common misconception – no throwaway distractors
- A student holding the misconception must be unable to reach the right answer by luck or elimination

Give me:

- The question and options
- The correct answer
- For each wrong option, exactly what the student is thinking
- What I do next for each: if most choose A, if most choose B, and so on

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is every distractor a real misconception you have seen?
- Could a confused student guess right? If so, it is not a hinge question.

LP-033**Create an exit ticket with secure, developing and not-yet response bands**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You want sorting, not scoring — three piles by the end of the corridor.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write an exit ticket for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [OBJECTIVE].

Design it so responses fall into three visibly different groups, sortable in under five minutes.

Give me:

- The question
- A model answer for a secure response
- A realistic developing response – right idea, incomplete
- A realistic not-yet response – the most common wrong route
- The single feature I look for to sort each pile quickly
- What I do tomorrow with each group

Do not use percentages or marks. I am sorting, not scoring.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the three sample responses realistically different?
- Is the sorting feature visible at a glance?

LP-034**Turn yesterday's exit-ticket patterns into today's opening task**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You read the exit tickets last night and want to act on them in the first five minutes.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Yesterday's [GRADE] [SUBJECT] exit ticket on [TOPIC] produced these patterns:

[DESCRIBE WHAT YOU SAW – e.g. "about half stopped after the first step; four reversed the operation; the rest were fine"]

Write today's opening task that addresses this without announcing who got it wrong.

Give me:

- A 5-7 minute opening that targets the main pattern
- How students who were already secure spend that time productively
- One sentence I say to frame it, that does not single anyone out
- What I check at the end of the opening before moving into today's lesson

Do not use any student names, and do not build anything that reveals who was in which group.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student work out who got it wrong? Redesign if so.
- Do the secure students have something real to do?

LP-035**Build a retrieval-practice warm-up without introducing new content**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Spacing things out so they stay learned, not just met.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a 5-minute retrieval warm-up for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Pull from:

- Last lesson: [TOPIC]
- Last month: [TOPIC]
- Last term: [TOPIC]

Six short questions, roughly two from each, mixed in order rather than grouped.

Every question must be answerable from memory – no new content, no reference material.

Give me the questions, the answers, and one line on why each item is worth keeping alive.

Then give me the version I would use next week, with the same structure but different items, so I can see the pattern and build my own.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is anything here actually new content in disguise?
- Are the older items ones you genuinely taught?

LP-036**Create a transfer exit ticket that cannot be answered by copying**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

They can do the examples from the board. You want to know if that means anything.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write an exit ticket for a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC] that a student cannot answer by copying the pattern from today's examples.

Today's examples were: [DESCRIBE OR PASTE THEM]

The question must need the same thinking in a different shape – different context, or the unknown in a different place.

Give me:

- The question
- The answer
- Exactly what a pattern-copier will write, and why it is wrong
- One sentence of feedback for that student that points at the thinking rather than the answer

Keep it to one question, answerable in four minutes.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is it genuinely different, or the same question with new numbers?
- Is it still fair — solvable from today's lesson, not tomorrow's?

LP-037**Audit an exit ticket for alignment, ambiguity and reading load**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The results were confusing and you suspect the question, not the students.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] exit ticket against the objective [OBJECTIVE].

Tell me:

- Whether a correct answer actually demonstrates the objective
- Any wording open to more than one reading, quoted exactly
- Whether the reading demand is higher than the subject demand – if a weak reader who understood the content would still get it wrong, say so
- Anything answerable by general reasoning without the lesson
- Whether it can honestly be done in the time given

Then give me a rewritten version fixing whatever you found, and say what you changed and why.

EXIT TICKET:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the rewrite still test the same objective?
- Is the reading level right for your actual class?

PACING AND TRANSITIONS

LP-038**Build a realistic minute-by-minute lesson timeline**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The plan is good and you keep running out of time at the same point.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a realistic minute-by-minute timeline for this [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson.

Class size: [NUMBER]. Room: [DESCRIBE].

Include the time nobody plans for: settling, handing out and collecting materials, moving between seating arrangements, repeating an instruction, packing up.

Give me:

- The timeline, with those overheads shown as their own lines
- The total, so I can see whether it exceeds the period
- The two segments most likely to overrun, and by how much
- What comes out if I am five minutes behind at the halfway point

Do not compress the overheads to make it fit. If it does not fit, tell me.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the overhead estimates realistic for your class?
- Does the total actually fit the period?

LP-039**Diagnose where a lesson is likely to run out of time**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you teach it, not after.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Look at this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson plan for [MINUTES] minutes and tell me where it will run out of time.

For each risk point:

- What takes longer than the plan assumes, and why
- A realistic estimate against the planned one
- Whether the overrun is avoidable or built into the activity

Then tell me the single change that buys the most time for the least loss, and what that loss is.

Assume a normal class, not an ideal one.

LESSON:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do the risk points match where you have run over before?
- Is the suggested cut one you can live with?

LP-040**Write concise transitions between lesson segments**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Each changeover costs three minutes and you have four of them.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write the transitions for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson.

For each changeover, give me:

- The exact words I say, under 15 seconds
- What students do with what they were holding
- How the next thing gets distributed or displayed
- The signal that tells me everyone is ready

Keep instructions to one action at a time. A [GRADE] class will do the first thing you say and forget the rest.

For the transition into group work, also tell me how groups form without a minute of negotiation.

LESSON:

[PASTE THE SEGMENTS]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is each instruction one action, or a list?
- Would these words sound like you saying them?

LP-041**Create a pacing contingency when discussion runs long**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The discussion is going well and you do not want to kill it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson, give me a contingency for when the discussion is genuinely productive and running over.

Give me:

- The decision point – at what time I decide, and what I am looking at
- What I cut, ranked, so I can cut one thing or three
- What I say to close the discussion without dismissing it
- How the lesson still ends with evidence, even in the shortest version
- The one thing I protect no matter what

Also tell me the signs that a discussion is running long because it is productive, versus running long because it has drifted.

LESSON:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the decision point early enough to act on?
- Does the shortest version still produce evidence?

LP-042**Plan meaningful early-finisher work connected to the objective**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Six students are done and you have eleven minutes left.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Students finishing [TASK] early in [GRADE] [SUBJECT] need work that extends the same thinking, not filler.

Give me five options that:

- Need no new instruction from me
- Take 5-15 minutes
- Use only what is already on their desk
- Could be shared with the class in one sentence

For each, say in one line what deeper thinking it demands.

No word searches, no coloring, and nothing that is simply more of the same questions. If a student would experience it as a punishment for working quickly, do not include it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a student see these as reward or punishment?
- Do they genuinely need no explanation from you?

LP-043**Adapt one lesson for both a regular period and a shortened schedule**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You teach the same lesson to two classes with different period lengths.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Adapt this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson so it works at both [LONGER] minutes and [SHORTER] minutes.

Give me:

- A shared core both versions contain
- What the longer version adds, and where it fits
- What the shorter version does differently – not just faster
- The check that is identical in both, so I can compare across classes
- What I lose in the shorter version, stated plainly

Do not produce the short version by cutting the end. The lesson has to finish in both.

LESSON:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the short version have a real ending?
- Is the shared check truly identical?

SUBSTITUTE AND EMERGENCY PLANS

LP-005**Create a no-surprises substitute lesson**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You are ill at 6am and someone who does not know your subject is covering.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a substitute plan for [GRADE] [SUBJECT], [NUMBER] periods of [MINUTES] minutes.

Assume the substitute does not know the subject and has never met the class. The work must be meaningful, not busywork, and need no preparation.

Give me:

- Three lines on what this class is like and what to watch for
- Minute-by-minute timing for the period
- Exactly what to write on the board
- The task written out in full, ready to photocopy
- What to do when students say we have already done this
- What to do if students finish early
- What to leave me a note about

Write it as one page a stranger can follow top to bottom without asking anyone.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could someone who has never taught your subject run this?
- Is anything here dependent on knowing your routines?

LP-044**Build an emergency no-print lesson from materials already in the room**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

No warning, no photocopier, whatever is in the cupboard.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write an emergency [MINUTES]-minute [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC] using only a board, students' own paper and pens, and their exercise books.

Nothing printed. Nothing prepared in advance. Nothing that needs a device.

Give me:

- What goes on the board, written exactly
- The task as I dictate it
- How students structure their answer on blank paper
- A partner check step
- How I collect or check the work in the last three minutes

Assume the substitute or I have had zero minutes to prepare. If the topic genuinely cannot be taught this way, say so and suggest a related one that can.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is there truly nothing needing preparation?
- Is dictating the task realistic for your class?

LP-045**Write exact substitute directions that require no subject guessing**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Your plan is good but the cover teacher filled the gaps wrong.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite these directions so a substitute who does not know [SUBJECT] can follow them without making any judgment calls.

For every step, replace anything requiring subject knowledge with an explicit instruction. If the plan says "discuss the answers", write out the answers.

Give me:

- The rewritten directions, numbered
- An answer key or model response for anything students produce
- Three questions students are likely to ask, with the exact reply
- What the substitute should do rather than guess, when something is not covered

Flag anything in my original that only works if the person already knows the subject.

DIRECTIONS:
[PASTE THEM]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does anything still assume subject knowledge?
- Are the answers correct? Check them yourself.

LP-046**Create a technology-failure backup for a digital lesson**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The lesson depends on devices and the devices are a gamble.

COPY THIS PROMPT

This [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson depends on [TECHNOLOGY]. Write the backup for when it does not work.

Give me:

- The same learning goal reached without any technology
- What I can prepare in advance so the switch takes under two minutes
- The point in the lesson by which I must decide to switch
- What is genuinely lost in the offline version, stated honestly
- What I say to the class about the change

The backup must be a real lesson, not twenty minutes of holding them until the period ends.

LESSON:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you actually prepare the backup in advance and keep it to hand?
- Is the decision point early enough?

LP-047**Prepare an independent catch-up lesson for an unexpected absence**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A student missed the lesson and you cannot reteach it one-to-one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

A [GRADE] student missed a [SUBJECT] lesson on [TOPIC]. Write something they can work through alone to catch up.

Give me:

- A short explanation of the idea, written to be read rather than taught
- One fully worked example with the reasoning shown, not just the steps
- Three practice items, increasing in difficulty, with answers
- A self-check: two questions that tell them whether they have got it
- One line telling them what to do if the self-check goes badly

Write it so a student reads it and works, without needing me to explain the explanation. Assume they may be doing this at home with no one to ask.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student genuinely follow this alone?
- Is the reading level right for the student who missed it?

LP-048**Audit a substitute plan for safety, clarity and collection procedures**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before you file it in the emergency folder and forget about it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this substitute plan for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Check for:

- Any step needing subject knowledge the substitute may not have
- Any instruction with more than one reasonable interpretation
- Anything requiring materials, access or permissions that may not be available
- Missing procedures: what happens to finished work, who to contact, what if a student leaves the room
- Anything with a safety implication that is not stated as an explicit instruction

Tell me the single most likely point of failure, and the smallest fix for it.

I will check anything safety-related against my school's own procedures.

PLAN:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check safety and emergency procedures against your school's policy.
- Is the collection procedure something the office would recognize?

PROJECTS AND INTERDISCIPLINARY

LP-049**Launch a project with a clear driving question and final product**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The first lesson of a project, which decides whether the rest works.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design the launch lesson for a [NUMBER]-week [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project on [TOPIC].

Give me:

- A driving question students cannot answer on day one but could by the end – open enough to sustain work, narrow enough to finish
- The final product, described as students will hear it
- The opening experience that makes the question feel worth answering
- What students produce by the end of this first lesson, so the launch is not only talk
- The three things students will ask immediately, with answers ready

Be honest about scope. If [NUMBER] weeks is not enough for this product, say so and suggest one that fits.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the driving question genuinely open, or a quiz question in disguise?
- Is the product achievable in the weeks you have?

LP-050**Connect two subjects around one authentic problem**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Cross-curricular work that is more than a shared theme word.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Design a [GRADE] project connecting [SUBJECT A] and [SUBJECT B] around a real problem.

The connection must be structural: the problem should be unsolvable using only one subject.

Give me:

- The problem, in student words
- What each subject contributes that the other cannot
- The specific learning from each subject that is genuinely used
- Where the two strands meet in the timeline
- How I assess each subject's learning separately, so one does not hide behind the other

If the honest connection is thin, say so rather than manufacturing one. A shared topic word is not a connection.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the connection structural or decorative?
- Can you separate the two subjects when grading?

LP-051**Break a multiweek project into milestones and checkpoints**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So you find out in week two, not week five.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Break this [NUMBER]-week [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project into milestones.

Give me:

- A milestone per week, each producing something I can actually look at
- What "on track" looks like at each, and what "behind" looks like
- The specific intervention for a group that is behind at each milestone
- The week where projects most commonly collapse, and the checkpoint that catches it
- What students see, so they can self-monitor without me chasing them

Each milestone should be checkable in under two minutes per group.

PROJECT:

[PASTE THE OUTLINE]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Can you really check each milestone in two minutes per group?
- Is the first checkpoint early enough to rescue a bad start?

LP-052**Create individual accountability inside a group project**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One student does everything and three collect the grade.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] group project, build in individual accountability.

Give me:

- A structure where each student produces something identifiably theirs
- An individual check that cannot be completed by a group member on someone else's behalf
- What I look at to see who understood, separately from what the group produced
- How I mark individual and group contributions without one swallowing the other
- What I do about a group where one student genuinely did most of the work

Do not rely on peer-rating forms as the main mechanism; build the accountability into the task itself.

PROJECT:

[PASTE THE OUTLINE]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a passenger still pass? Redesign if so.
- Is the individual check quick enough to run for every student?

LP-053**Design a project rubric that measures learning rather than decoration**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The best-looking poster keeps getting the best grade.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a rubric for this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project.

Learning it should evidence: [WHAT STUDENTS SHOULD BE ABLE TO DO]

Rules:

- Most of the weight goes to thinking and subject learning
- Presentation is one small criterion, described in terms of whether it helps the reader – not effort or neatness
- Every criterion is something I can point at in the work
- Nothing rewards resources students may not have at home

Give me the criteria, what each looks like at proficient, and one sentence of feedback I could reuse for the most common near-miss on each.

Then tell me which criterion a student could game with effort but no learning.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a beautiful project with weak thinking score well? Fix if so.
- Does anything advantage students with better resources at home?

LP-054**Plan a public-product option that protects student privacy**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Real audience, real stakes — without putting children online.

COPY THIS PROMPT

For this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] project, design an option where students present to a real audience without exposing their identities or personal information.

Give me:

- Three audience options ranging from inside school to outside it
- For each, exactly what is shared and what is not
- How students are credited without full names or images
- What has to be checked or permitted before anything leaves the classroom
- An equivalent alternative for a student who cannot participate publicly, that is not visibly a lesser option

Do not suggest anything requiring students to hold personal accounts on public platforms.

I will confirm all of this against my school's own consent and child-protection policy.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check against your school's consent policy before anything is shared.
- Is the alternative genuinely equivalent, or obviously the lesser option?

REFLECTION AND ADAPTATION

LP-055**Turn lesson evidence into a next-day adjustment**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You have the exit tickets in front of you and tomorrow to plan.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here is what I saw in [GRADE] [SUBJECT] today on [TOPIC]:

[DESCRIBE THE EVIDENCE – exit ticket patterns, what you heard while circulating, what students got stuck on. No names.]

Tell me:

- What this evidence supports concluding, and what it does not
- The one adjustment for tomorrow that addresses the most students
- What that adjustment costs – what gets pushed back
- What I should look for tomorrow to know whether it worked
- Anything in my description that is my interpretation rather than what I observed

Do not recommend reteaching the whole lesson unless the evidence supports it.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the conclusion actually follow from what you saw?
- Is the adjustment small enough to do tonight?

LP-056**Write a post-lesson reflection based on observations rather than feelings alone**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

"It went badly" is not something you can act on next week.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me turn this into a useful reflection on a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson.

What happened: [DESCRIBE IT, INCLUDING HOW IT FELT]

Give me:

- What I actually observed, separated from what I concluded about it
- Three alternative explanations for what I observed, including ones that are not about my teaching
- What evidence would tell me which explanation is right
- One thing to try next time, and what I would watch to know whether it helped
- What was fine, so I do not change something that was working

Do not reassure me. I want the analysis.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the alternative explanations ones you had not considered?
- Is the "next time" specific enough to actually do?

LP-057**Identify what to keep, change and investigate after a lesson**

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A quick sort, five minutes after the class leaves.

COPY THIS PROMPT

From this account of a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson, sort it into three lists:

KEEP – worked, and I know why

CHANGE – did not work, and the fix is clear

INVESTIGATE – did not work, but I do not yet know why

For the CHANGE list, give me the specific fix.

For the INVESTIGATE list, give me the one question to answer next lesson and how I would find out.

If something belongs in INVESTIGATE, do not move it to CHANGE by guessing at a cause. Say plainly that the cause is unknown.

LESSON ACCOUNT:

[DESCRIBE WHAT HAPPENED – no student names]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has anything been moved to CHANGE that you do not actually understand yet?
- Is the KEEP list honest, or padded?

LP-058**Adapt a lesson after most learners miss the same misconception**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It is not a few students. It is most of the class, making the same error.

COPY THIS PROMPT

In [GRADE] [SUBJECT], most of the class made this error on [TOPIC]:

[DESCRIBE THE ERROR PRECISELY – what they did, not what they failed to do]

Tell me:

- What thinking produces this error – the reasoning behind it, not just the fault
- Whether anything in a normal explanation of this topic actively encourages it
- A lesson that confronts the misconception directly rather than re-explaining the correct method
- The example that makes the misconception visibly fail
- How I check next lesson whether the old idea has genuinely gone, rather than gone quiet

Re-teaching the same way more slowly is not the answer I am looking for.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the explanation of their thinking ring true?
- Does the confronting example genuinely break under the misconception?

LP-059**Plan targeted follow-up for three anonymous response patterns**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Three distinct groups, one lesson, no way to run three lessons.

COPY THIS PROMPT

After a [GRADE] [SUBJECT] check on [TOPIC], responses fell into three patterns:

Pattern A: [DESCRIBE] – roughly [NUMBER] students

Pattern B: [DESCRIBE] – roughly [NUMBER] students

Pattern C: [DESCRIBE] – roughly [NUMBER] students

Plan a single [MINUTES]-minute lesson that moves all three forward.

Give me:

- What each group needs, in one line
- A shared opening all three can do
- The differentiated middle, with what each group works on
- Where I spend my time, and in what order
- A shared closing task that works for all three
- How groups are formed without labeling anyone

No student names, and nothing that makes the grouping visible as ability.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could students decode the grouping? Change it if so.
- Does the group you are not sitting with have work they can do alone?

LP-060**Compare the intended lesson with what learners actually demonstrated**

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The lesson happened. Whether the learning did is a separate question.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Compare what this [GRADE] [SUBJECT] lesson intended with what students actually demonstrated.

INTENDED: [THE OBJECTIVE]

DEMONSTRATED: [WHAT THE WORK OR RESPONSES ACTUALLY SHOWED – no names]

Tell me:

- Where the gap is: was it the teaching, the task, the check, or the objective
- What the evidence supports, and where I would be over-reading it
- Whether the check was capable of showing the objective at all
- What I would need to see to be confident, and how to get it next lesson
- If the objective was too large for one lesson, say so

Be specific about which of the four is the problem. "A bit of everything" is not useful to me.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Do you agree with where it located the gap?
- Was your check ever capable of showing the objective?